Land At South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420
Eastern Villages Swindon
Archaeology – Outline Management Plan (all phases)
March 2023

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Report
Archaeology – Outline Management Plan (all phases)

Site
Land At South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon

Client
Hallam Land Management, Taylor Wimpey & Hannick Homes

Date
March 2023

Planning Authority
Swindon Borough Council

Site Centred At
546936 249698

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Report Status
Final

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Timescales Used in This Report

Prehistoric

Palaeolithic	450,000 -12,000 BC
Mesolithic	12,000 - 4,000 BC
Neolithic	4,000 - 2,200 BC
Bronze Age	2,200 - 700 BC
Iron Age	700 - AD 43

Historic

Roman	43 - 410AD
Saxon/Early Medieval	410 - 1066AD
Medieval	1066 - 1485AD
Post Medieval	1486 - 1901AD
Modern	1901 - Present Day

1.0 Introduction

Project background and purpose of document

1.1 This document represents an Archaeological Management Plan for Land North of the A420 at South Marston and Rowborough (Figure 1).

1.2 The purpose of the Archaeological Management Plan is to inform both the current and prospective owners/managers of the sensitivity and management issues relating to the development site, to assess the previous and current management regimes and to identify a list of management aims and objectives that will be agreed to by all parties in relation to the current and future management of the areas of the site retained as open space. Four areas of open space have been agreed to be retained as open space. These are described as Preservation Areas and also correspond to phases of development (Figure 2).

1.3 Outline planning permission has been granted for a urban extension to the east of Swindon and north of the A420 for up to 2,380 dwellings together with a mixed use local centre/areas (including A1 retail up to 1,500 sq. metres, services (A2), restaurants, pubs and takeaways (A3, A4, A5) business uses (B1) up to 1,000 sq. metres, residential); community uses (D1), sheltered and/or care accommodation (C2/C3), two primary schools, green infrastructure including formal (including playing fields) and informal open space, landscape, bio diversity and amenity space, play space (including LEPS/NEAPS/MUGA), changing and sports facilities (including D2 and ancillary retail uses), sustainable drainage systems, highway, cycle and pedestrian routes, car parking, infrastructure (including utilities), engineering works including ground remodelling, demolition, site reclamation and removal of structures, the formation of new accesses from the A420, Old Vicarage Lane and Thornhill Road (Swindon Borough Council application ref S/OUT/13/1555).

1.4 Outline planning permission has been granted with two conditions in relation to archaeology. This document relates to planning condition 39 which is as follows:

39. Archaeology – Management Plan
Prior to the commencement of development in each sub-phase, a detailed management plan for that sub-phase shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority to ensure the preservation in situ of areas of archaeological importance as indicated in Figure 17 of the Outline Archaeological Mitigation Strategy (V6 - 31st October 2017). No development shall take place except in accordance with the approved details.

Reason: To ensure areas of known archaeological significance are preserved in situ and appropriately managed in the long term and during the construction phase of the development.

1.5 This Outline Archaeological Management Plan (all phases) provides the framework, principles and parameters which will be used for the detailed management plans required for each phase of development. This includes areas of mitigation and areas to be retained as open space and covered by a Management Plan (Figure 3).

1.6 Planning condition 38 relates to a programme of archaeological works which is outlined in the following document: Site-wide Overarching Archaeological Written Scheme of Investigation (Orion 2022).

1.7 There are no strict guidelines for the production of archaeological management plans, however, the HLF has published useful guidance (HLF 2022). This management plan has also been informed by 'Conservation Principles Policies and Guidance for the Sustainable Management of the Historic Environment (English Heritage 2008).

Previous investigations

1.8 This document is informed by:

- Outline Archaeological Mitigation Strategy (Orion Heritage 2017)
- Site-Wide Overarching Archaeological Written Scheme of Investigation (Orion Heritage 2022)
- Trial trench evaluation. The site has been subject to various phases of trial trench evaluation undertaken at different times by Foundations Archaeology and Cotswold Archaeology.
- Geophysical Survey. The site has been subject to various phases of geophysical survey which are detailed below. The most recent survey was completed in May 2022 by SUMO.

1.9 The Foundations Archaeology evaluation targeted the proposed main access road from Thornhill Road that will run through the settlement. The first phase of the Cotswold Archaeology trenching targeted the eastern area of this complex of anomalies. The trenching established that the geophysical survey results were correct and reliable. Although hand excavation of features during the Foundations Archaeology work was hampered by a very high-water table, the trenching demonstrated that the settlement that had Late Iron Age origins and continued into the early 2nd century AD. The eastern edge of the settlement as identified in the geophysical survey, has been established to be real as Trenches 16-18 revealed Roman features on slightly elevated ground above the wetter slightly lower land to east where Trenches 22, 31 & 32 failed to reveal Roman features, presumably to avoid the flooding to which the area to the east may have been prone.

1.10 The archaeological background to the has previously been detailed in a Cultural Heritage Assessment (CgMs 2014). The assessment confirmed that there are no scheduled monuments, registered parks and gardens, battlefields or conservation areas within the Application Site or the wider Study Area.

Context

1.11 The area of the Management Plan has been visited on a number of occasions over a 15-year period to assess the setting of the site and to monitor on site works. The spacing of the site visits allows an appreciation of the setting during winter, spring and autumn.

2.0 Preservation Area 1/South Marston East (South Marston Phase 1)

2.1 Preservation Area 1 forms part of South Marston East (Phase 1) (Figure 3 & 4). Preservation Area 1 comprises a single parcel of land which extends from Thornhill Road in the west to Old Vicarage Lane in the east. It extends from the railway line in the south to Red House in the north.

2.2 Preservation Area 1 is currently agricultural in character forming a number of enclosure agricultural fields. Preservation Area 1 is generally flat located at 100m OD sloping gently to the south and east. The current field boundaries are post-medieval in date and do not respond to the sub-surface archaeological settlement pattern.

2.3 The archaeological resource within the area of the Management Plan does not currently receive any active management. The archaeological remains survive below ground with no extant earthworks and as such are not visually perceptible. There is no interpretation in relation to the archaeological remains.

2.4 The site is private land. A number of public rights of way are located within Preservation Area 1, a number crossing the site in a north-south orientation between South Marston Farm and Manor Farm and to the north and one crossing the south of the site in an east-west orientation.

Summary description

2.5 The archaeological resource within Preservation Area 1 comprises buried non-designated archaeological remains largely identified by geophysical survey (Archaeological Services University of Durham 2006 and 2008; Stratascan 2013 and 2014). Previous intrusive archaeological investigation has been completed within Preservation Area 1 and the wider Outline Application area by Foundations Archaeology in 2014, and two phases of evaluation by Cotswold Archaeology in 2015.

2.6 The existing baseline information indicates the presence of a significant and multi-period archaeological landscape covering the area west of and north of South Marston Farm. Preservation Area 1, in particular the area immediately north and west of South Marston Farm, contains the southern and western parts of this rich and dense multi-period landscape (see 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 11, 12, 13 and 14 on Figure 4 and within Table 1 below). Assessment of the geophysical survey data identifies a dense distribution of probable archaeological features which includes presumed settlement enclosures, (including stock enclosures, field systems and both rectilinear and circular features). There appear to be numerous pit-like features. Trenching, albeit limited, demonstrated that the settlement that had Late Iron Age origins and continued into the early 2nd century AD. The potential for earlier or later archaeological remains within the complex cannot be ruled out entirely.

2.7 The western extent of the settlement within the Preservation Area 1 identified in the geophysical survey have been confirmed by the Foundations Archaeology trenching as Trenches 1 & 2 revealed few archaeological features. As such this area contains less dense / complex archaeology comprising ditches and pits which may represent enclosures or ring-ditches (see 17 on Figure 5 and within Table 1 below).

2.8 Occupation evidence extends to the area east of South Marston Farm, albeit less dense / complex according to the geophysics. This includes a number of enclosures, trackways (including a metalled surface of a former road or trackway), pits and structural features

which lies adjacent to Preservation Area 1 (see 18, 19 and 20 in Figure 4 and within Table 1 below). Some of these features extend within the Preservation Area 1 (see 18).

2.9 To the east of this a rectilinear negative anomaly, possibly reflecting a walled enclosure, an associated metalled track, and internal positive and dipolar magnetic anomalies probably reflecting structures, pits and gullies is recorded (see 22 on Figure 4 and within table 1 below). Linear ditches, possible field system or enclosure are recorded to the north of this (see 26 in Figure 5 and within table 1 below).

2.10 No archaeology is recorded in the northern part of Preservation Area 1.

2.11 The south-eastern part of Preservation Area 1 is charactered by ridge and furrow (see 29 in Figure 4 and within Table 1 below) and possible truncated remains of pits and gullies (see 23 and 25 in Figure 4 and within Table 1 below).

2.12 The following gazetteer lists, where possible, individual features identified by geophysical survey. These are mapped on Figure 4.

Table 1: Features identified by geophysical survey within Preservation Area 1

Orion Feature No.	Feature description from original report	Original report	Original feature no.
3	Traces of medieval ridge and furrow in Areas 1 and 2	ASDU 2008	F16
4	A large rectilinear enclosure, approximately 40m by 60m and oriented on a northwest-southeast alignment, frames the T-junction of the two roads.	ASDU 2008	F8
5	Double-ditched trackway or road	ASDU 2008	F7
6			
7	Large pit feature	ASDU 2008	F14
8	Probably T-junction of soil-filled ditches	ASDU 2008	F13
9	Probable ditch	ASDU 2008	F15
10	Double-ditched trackway or road in Areas 1 and 2	ASDU 2008	F7
11	Double-ditched trackway or road in Areas 1 and 2	ASDU 2008	F6
12	Two rectilinear enclosures containing many positive magnetic anomalies, possibly reflecting internal ditches, pits and gullies	ASDU 2008	F9
13	Large probable pit	ASDU 2008	F10
14	Large probable pit	ASDU 2008	F11
17	A complex of linear, curvilinear and rectilinear positive magnetic anomalies, as well as discrete positive magnetic anomalies, has been detected in this area. These almost certainly reflect soil-filled features such as ditches and pits, with some anomalies suggesting enclosures, ring-ditches and concentrations of pits.	ASDU 2006	
18	Possible metalled surface of a former road or trackway which diverges around enclosure F28	ASDU 2008	F27
19	Enclosure with internal structures and pits **adjacent** to Area 1	ASDU 2008	F28
20	Enclosures, trackways, pits and possibly structural features	ASDU 2008	F30
21	Ridge and furrow	ASDU 2008	F32
22	Rectilinear negative anomaly, possibly reflecting a walled enclosure, an associated metalled track, and internal positive and dipolar magnetic anomalies probably reflecting structures, pits and gullies.	ASDU 2008	F29
23	Possible truncated remains of pits and gullies	ASDU 2008	F31
24	Traces of ridge and furrow	ASDU 2008	F33
25	Possible truncated remains of pits and gullies	ASDU 2008	F31
26	Linear ditches, possible field system or enclosure	Stratascan 2013	4
29	Ridge and furrow		

32	Possible enclosure of prehistoric date, approximately 40m square and contains two further positive magnetic curvilinear anomalies: a possible ditch or gully and a possible a ring ditch or internal structure such as a roundhouse **adjacent** to Area 1	ASDU 2008	Area 5 F38

3.0 Preservation Area 2/South Marston West (South Marston Phase 2)

3.1 Preservation Area 2 forms part of South Marston West (Phase 2) (Figure 3 and 5). It comprises three separate parcels of land, the largest covering the area adjacent to Thornhill Road and north of the temporary haul road. Two smaller parcels of land to the east form part of Preservation Area 2, to the north and south of the temporary haul road.

3.2 Preservation Area 2 is currently agricultural in character forming a number of enclosure agricultural fields. Preservation Area 2 is generally flat at located at 100m OD sloping gently to the south and east. The current field boundaries are post-medieval in date and do not respond to the sub-surface archaeological settlement pattern.

3.3 The archaeological resource within the area of the Management Plan does not currently receive any active management. The archaeological remains survive below ground with no extant earthworks and as such are not visually perceptible. There is no interpretation in relation to the archaeological remains.

3.4 The site is private land. A number of public rights of way are located within Preservation Area 2, a number crossing the site in a north-south orientation between South Marston Farm and Manor Farm.

Summary Description

3.5 The archaeological resource within Preservation Area 2 comprises buried non-designated archaeological remains largely identified by geophysical survey (Archaeological Services University of Durham 2006 and 2008; Stratascan 2013 and 2014). Previous intrusive archaeological investigation has been completed within Preservation Area 2 and the wider Outline Application area by Foundations Archaeology in 2014, and two phases of evaluation by Cotswold Archaeology in 2015.

3.6 The existing baseline information indicates the presence of a significant and multi-period archaeological landscape covering the area west of and north of South Marston Farm and south of Manor Farm. Preservation Area 2, in particular the area south of Manor Farm, contains the northern and western parts of this rich and dense multi-period landscape (see 2, 3, 7, 15 on Figure 5 and within Table 2 below). Assessment of the geophysical survey data identifies a dense distribution of probable archaeological features which includes presumed settlement enclosures, (including stock enclosures, field systems and both rectilinear and circular features). There appear to be numerous pit-like features. Trenching, albeit limited, demonstrated that the settlement that had Late Iron Age origins and continued into the early 2nd century AD. The potential for earlier or later archaeological remains within the complex cannot be ruled out entirely.

3.7 The western extent of the settlement within the Preservation Area 2 identified in the geophysical survey have been confirmed by the Foundations Archaeology trenching as Trenches 1 & 2 revealed few archaeological features. As such this area contains less dense / complex archaeology comprising ditches and pits and ridge and furrow (see 1 and 16 on Figure 6 and within Table 2 below).

3.8 The eastern parcels of land that form part of Preservation Area 2 contain non-designated archaeological remains which include linear ditches, possible field system or enclosure (see 26 in Figure 5 and within Table 2 below). These may be Iron Age – Romano-British or medieval in date.

3.9 There is general potential for evidence of medieval and post-medieval agricultural activity and land-management.

3.10 The following gazetteer lists, where possible, individual features identified by geophysical survey. These are mapped on Figure 5.

Table 2: Features identified by geophysical survey within Preservation Area 2

Orion Feature No.	Feature description from original report	Original report	Original feature no.
1	Soil-filled ditch and pit features	ASDU 2008	F25
2	Possible boundary or enclosure ditch	ASDU 2008	F12
3	Traces of medieval ridge and furrow	ASDU 2008	F16
7	A complex of magnetic anomalies has been recorded. The features identified comprise presumed settlement enclosures, (including stock enclosures, field systems and both rectilinear and circular features). There appear to be numerous pit-like features. The complex of features is very extensive and suggests multiperiod activity.	Stratascan 2013	5
10	Double-ditched trackway or road in Areas 1 and 2	ASDU 2008	F7
11	Double-ditched trackway or road in Areas 1 and 2	ASDU 2008	F6
15	Traces of medieval ridge and furrow	ASDU 2008	F17
16	Ridge and furrow	ASDU 2008	F26
27	Iron Age 'ladder-type' settlement	Stratascan 2013	Field 1
28	Presumed settlement enclosures, field systems and both rectilinear and circular features	Stratascan 2013	3

4.0 Preservation Area 3/Rowborough Central (Rowborough Phase 1)

4.1 Preservation Area 3 forms part of Rowborough Central (Rowborough Phase 1) (Figure 3 and 6). It comprises four separate parcels of land, three irregular parcels of land north-west of Rowborough Farm and a large irregular parcel of land north of the railway line which extends from Old Vicarage Lane in the west to Nightingale Wood in the east.

4.2 Preservation Area 3 is currently agricultural in character forming a number of enclosure agricultural fields. Preservation Area 3 is generally flat located at 100m OD sloping gently to the south and east. The current field boundaries are post-medieval in date and do not respond to the sub-surface archaeological settlement pattern.

4.3 The archaeological resource within Preservation Area 3 does not currently receive any active management. The archaeological remains survive below ground with no extant earthworks and as such are not visually perceptible. There is no interpretation in relation to the archaeological remains.

4.4 The site is private land. A public right of way is located within Preservation Area 3, which crosses from the south-east of the area past Rowborough Farm and to the north-west.

Summary Description

4.5 The archaeological resource within Preservation Area 3 comprises buried non-designated archaeological remains largely identified by geophysical survey (Archaeological Services University of Durham 2006 and 2008; Stratascan 2013 and 2014). Previous intrusive archaeological investigation has been completed within Preservation Area 3 and the wider Outline Application area by Foundations Archaeology in 2014, and two phases of evaluation by Cotswold Archaeology in 2015.

4.6 Unlike Preservation Areas 1 and 2, Preservation Area 3 does not target a concentration of significant multi-period archaeological evidence. Preservation Area 3 contains outlying areas of known occupation activity, although it should be noted that archaeological investigations within this area is more limited.

4.7 Preservation Area 3 comprises two separate areas. The area to the north-west of Rowborough Farm comprises areas around an area of known archaeology comprising four large circular features identified by geophysical survey (see 33 on Figure 6 and within Table 3 below) have been investigated by Cotswold Archaeology (Trenches 40, 43 & 44). A sherd of Beaker/early Bronze Age pottery was recovered from the most easterly ring ditch, indicating that these features are likely to be late Neolithic/early Bronze Age in date. There was no evidence for central burials in the central and eastern ring ditches. The function of these features is unclear based on the evaluation results, but it is considered that they are most likely the remains of Bronze Age barrows or the drip gullies of round houses. This area also includes Iron Age occupation in the form of enclosures, possible track or drove ways and associated features. Based on the work to date these are tentatively dated to the early-mid Iron Age.

4.8 The Cotswold Archaeology trenching has established that a series of multiple east-west orientated ditches identified during the geophysical survey to the west of Rowborough Farm are Roman in date. Two linear anomalies were also recorded immediately to the north-east of Rowborough on exactly the same alignment. Preservation Area 3 lies between these two areas, and it is therefore likely that associated remains fall within

Preservation Area 3. The Foundations Archaeology trenching revealed that these linears were a metalled trackway for which there was no dating evidence, but it was presumed to be relatively recent. However, the alignment of the trackway is exactly the same as the ditches recorded in the Cotswold Archaeology Trench 42 and so it is possible that the metalled feature is in fact much older than interpreted in the evaluation report or that it follows a much older boundary. Cotswold Archaeology have postulated that these features may be the remains of an important land boundary.

4.9 Geophysical survey of the area west of Rowborough Farm concluded low potential for anomalies of archaeological origin (see 30 on Figure 6 and within Table 3 below).

4.10 The majority of the large irregular parcel of land which forms the southern part of Preservation Area 3 has not been subject to archaeological investigation. The eastern limit falls within an area which has been subject to geophysical survey. This identified several positive magnetic anomalies which could reflect pits and gullies (see 31 on Figure 6 and within Table 3 below) associated with the possible enclosure to the north (see 32 on Figure 6 and within Table 3 below).

4.11 There is general potential for evidence of medieval and post-medieval agricultural activity and land-management.

4.12 The following gazetteer lists, where possible, individual features identified by geophysical survey. These are mapped on Figure 6.

Table 3: Features identified by geophysical survey within Preservation Area 3

Orion Feature No.	Feature description from original report	Original report	Original feature no.
30	Low potential for anomalies of archaeological origin; disturbance noted which may reflect recent turf cutting and lifting.	ASDU 2006	Area A
31	Several positive magnetic anomalies which could reflect pits and gullies associated with the possible enclosure (32).	ASDU 2008	Area 5 F43
33	At least three ring ditches, a rectangular enclosure, linear ditches and a possible trackway **adjacent** to Area 3	Stratascan 2013	Field 15, (6), (7) and (8)

5.0 Preservation Area 4 / Rowborough North (Rowborough Phase 2)

5.1 Preservation Area 4 forms part of Rowborough Central (Rowborough Phase 2) (Figure 3 and 7). It comprises a single small parcel of land north of Rowborough Farm.

5.2 Preservation Area 4 is currently agricultural in character forming part of an enclosed agricultural field. Preservation Area 4 is generally flat at located at 100m OD.

5.3 The archaeological resource within Preservation Area 4 does not currently receive any active management. The archaeological remains survive below ground with no extant earthworks and as such are not visually perceptible. There is no interpretation in relation to the archaeological remains.

5.4 The site is private land. No public rights of way are located within Preservation Area 4.

Summary Description

5.5 Unlike Preservation Areas 1 and 2, Preservation Area 4 does not target a concentration of significant multi-period archaeological evidence.

5.6 Preservation Area 4 lies adjacent to an area of known archaeology comprising four large late Neolithic/early Bronze Age ring ditches and Iron Age enclosures, possible trackways or drove ways (see 33 on Figure 8 and within Table 3 below). Trench 80 falls partially within Preservation Area 4, which was negative, although it should be noted that archaeological investigations within this area is more limited.

5.7 No known archaeological remains are located within this area, however there is potential for previously unrecorded prehistoric – Roman buried archaeological remains.

6.0 Construction Phase Management Plan

Introduction

6.1 Conservation has been defined as "the process of managing change in ways that will best sustain the values of a place in its contexts, and which recognises opportunities to reveal or reinforce those values" (English Heritage Conservation Principles 5.1).

6.2 The management and mitigation of change to the heritage resource resulting from development is based on the recognition within Government planning objectives that "…heritage assets are an irreplaceable resource…" (NPPF para. 126). Impacts to the historic environment and its associated heritage assets arise where changes are made to their physical environment by means of the loss and/or degradation of their physical fabric or setting, which in turn leads to a reduction in the significance of the historic environment record and its associated heritage assets.

6.3 The underpinning principle guiding this document can be defined as the physical protection of buried archaeological remains to ensure the preservation of the archaeological interest for this and future generations.

6.4 It is of the upmost importance that whoever take ultimate responsibility or ownership of the Site (or Preservation Area) must be made aware of:

- The archaeological significance of the Site
- the conditions set out in this management plan
- their responsibilities regarding the implementation of the Construction Phase Management Plan
- the potential financial implications of the implementation of the Management Plan

Construction Phase Potential Impacts (All Phases)

6.5 As there are no upstanding monuments within the site, the archaeological resource comprises entirely below ground remains. The in-situ archaeological remains at the site are protected to some degree by the overlying topsoil horizon. To facilitate the survival of the remains it is crucial that this topsoil lay is not compromised.

6.6 Factors which would compromise the protective topsoil horizon include:

- Any Machine Excavation
- Any Hand Excavation
- Excessive Compression
- Working in Saturated Conditions (Prolonged Precipitation)
- Vehicle Rutting or Track Slew Damage
- Any Ploughing
- Tree or Hedge Planting:
- Grubbing Out Sections Hedging
- Storage of Materials on Archaeologically Sensitive Areas
- Boring or Tunnelling
- Landscaping and construction of earthworks

Construction Phase Management Policies (All Phases)

6.7 To ensure long term preservation of the Site a series of Construction Phase Preservation (CPP) Polices have been formulated. Certain activities within and adjacent to the Site must

be prohibited, restricted or subject to condition to ensure long term preservation of the Site.

CPP1 General Approach

The area of known archaeology contributes to our understanding of the development over time of the landscape in this part of Swindon and as such it is important to adopt a precautionary approach to the management of this resource during construction. The approach for the design and management of the site is to protect and conserve this area of known archaeology.

CPP2 Responsibility

The adoption and adherence of the Construction Phase (CPP) Polices is a vital part of the preservation of the heritage resource at the Site. Adherence to the CPP Polices will have financial implications for the ultimate owner or guardian of the Site. From the outset, it must be made clear to the ultimate owner or guardian of their responsibilities regarding the implementation of the Construction Phase Management Plan and the CPP Polices.

Actions:

- A detailed management plan shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority to discharge condition 39 for each phase.
- Compliance with the Management Plan is the responsibility of the site owner or delegated to a specialist consultant as appropriate, both during construction and in the long term.
- In order to ensure compliance with the Management Plan it is recommended that the Site Condition Assessment be conducted at three-month intervals (unless otherwise stated in the detailed management plan for each phase) during the construction phase of the development, including implementation of landscaping plans. The Site Condition Assessment should be undertaken by a CIFA Registered Organisation, in accordance with the approved detailed Written Scheme of Investigation for the relevant phase and in consultation with the Archaeological Advisor to SBC. This will include site photographs of the management area, a statement that the management policies have been complied with and highlighting of any new management issues that may have arisen to the Archaeological Advisor to SBC and the owner of the site (see Long Term Site Condition Assessment Section below).

Reason: to ensure the physical preservation of the sub-surface and extant archaeological remains.

CPP3: Ensure preservation of the archaeological resource during detailed design / RMA.

F*uture detailed designs will ensure that the archaeological resource within the area of the Management Plan is adequately protected from damage by landscaping, planting or vegetation management.*

Actions:

- A detailed management plan shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority to discharge condition 39 for each phase.
- Although a pre-commencement condition it is recommended that this is undertaken at RMA stage to ensure the proposals are compliant with the principles of this document prior to the design being fixed.
- This overarching Conservation Management Plan should be circulated to the wider design and construction team during each phases RMA and the proposals should illustrate / reference this overarching management plan.

- The detailed management plans for each phase should include an impact assessment of landscape / ecology / arboriculture / drainage / service proposals and Construction Management Plans (CEMP) to demonstrate that the principles and parameters defined by this document have been adhered to.
- In the event that physical impacts are identified, the detailed management plan will include the results of discussions with the Archaeological Advisor to SBC regarding an agreed response.

Reason: to ensure the physical preservation of the sub-surface and extant archaeological remains.

CPP4: Prevent any compromise of the Topsoil Horizon by direct construction activity
Areas of known archaeological significance within the area of the Management Plan will be preserved in situ.
Actions:

- There shall be no machine excavation in any part of the Site, at any time; and
- In the event that groundworks are required within the area of the management plan (for example associated with excavation of services, drainage or for ecological reasons), details will be submitted to the archaeological consultant to discuss and agree with the Archaeological Advisor to SBC whether it acceptable and / or requires an archaeological response.

Reason: to ensure the physical preservation of the sub-surface and extant archaeological remains. To ensure compliance with local and national planning policy and guidance.

CPP4: Prevent any compromise of the Topsoil Horizon by secondary construction activity
Areas of known archaeological significance within the area of the Management Plan may be harmed by the tracking of construction vehicles; the storage of material can lead to issues such as increased topsoil damage and contamination.
Actions:

- The area identified within the Management Plan will be adequately protected during enabling or construction works associated with the wider development. This will include the erection of a temporary fence along the edge of the main road excavation and temporary haul road to completely restrict potentially damaging construct traffic within the Management Plan area. The temporary fencing should be non-intrusive, such as a Heras type system.
- The area covered by the Management Plan will not be used for temporary storage or parking.
- Measures should be put in place to inform any construction crew of the issues related to this Site.

Reason: to ensure the physical preservation of the sub-surface and extant archaeological remains.

CPP5: Prevent any compromise of the Topsoil Horizon by Information Signage
The location, arrangement and erection of information panels at the Site must be balanced against potential negative impacts to the archaeological resource. Such impacts might include:

- Damage to archaeological layers by the excavation of ballast foundations for the information panels.
- Damage to archaeological layers by increased footfall erosion adjacent to the information panels.

- It is recommended that the number of information panels should be kept to a minimum, but these panels should be located where they can be utilised by the maximum number of people

Reason: to enhance the heritage amenity of the site as a public asset and, in doing so, to foster public appreciation and a sense of community value.

7.0 Long-Term Preservation Management Plan (All Phases)

7.1 There are a number of factors which will successfully facilitate the long-term archaeological preservation of the Site. An important factor in ensuring the long-term preservation of the Site is the correct implementation of the Construction Phase Management Plan (Section 5). Although every effort has been made to ensure that the Policies listed in the Construction Phase Management Plan enable the preservation of the archaeological resource at the Site, further measures will need to be put in place to guarantee long term preservation.

7.2 It is of the upmost importance that whoever take ultimate responsibility or ownership of the Site (or Preservation Area) must be made aware of:

- The archaeological significance of the Site;
- the conditions set out in this management plan;
- their responsibilities regarding the implementation of the Long-Term Preservation Management Plan; and
- the potential financial implications of the implementation of the Management Plan.

7.3 This Long-Term Preservation Management Plan can only remain valid if the function of the Site remains the same. If in the future, there is a proposed change in function of the Site, or a significant expansion to one or any element of the Site, a new Management Plan must be formulated in consultation with the Local Planning Authority.

Long Term Phase Risks (All Phases)

7.4 As there are no upstanding monuments within the site, the archaeological resource comprises entirely below ground remains. The in-situ archaeological remains at the site are protected to some degree by the overlying topsoil horizon. To facilitate the survival of the remains it is crucial that this topsoil lay is not compromised.

7.5 Factors which would compromise the protective topsoil horizon include:

- Any Machine Excavation
- Any Hand Excavation
- Excessive Compression
- Working in Saturated Conditions (Prolonged Precipitation)
- Vehicle Rutting or Track Slew Damage
- Any Ploughing
- Tree or Hedge Planting:
- Grubbing Out Sections Hedging
- Storage of Materials on Archaeologically Sensitive Areas
- Boring or Tunnelling
- Landscaping and construction of earthworks

Long Term Preservation Management Policies (All Phases)

7.6 To ensure long term preservation of the Site a series of Long-Term Preservation (LTP) Polices have been formulated. Certain activities within and adjacent to the Site must be prohibited, restricted or subject to condition to ensure long term preservation of the Site.

LTP1 General Approach

The area of known archaeology contributes to our understanding of the development over time of the landscape in this part of Swindon and as such it is important to adopt a

precautionary approach to the long-term management of this resource. The approach for the design and management of the site is to protect and conserve this area of known archaeology.

LTP2 Responsibility

The adoption and adherence of the Long-Term Preservation (LTP) Polices is a vital part of the long-term preservation of the heritage resource at the Site. Adherence to the LTP Polices will have financial implications for the ultimate owner or guardian of the Site. From the outset, it must be made clear to the ultimate owner or guardian of their responsibilities regarding the implementation of the Long-Term Preservation Management Plan and the LTP Polices.

LTP3 Installation of Infrastructure

The installation of access, fencing and signage in and around the area of known archaeology has the potential to negatively impact the below ground archaeological resource. Any changes that might involve breaking ground, such as the installation of foundations or setting of fence posts, either in or adjacent to the area of known archaeology, shall require prior approval by Swindon Borough Council to prevent and / or reduce any negative impact caused by these activities.

LPT4 Cultivation

Long term cultivation plans will be secured during the detailed management plans for each phase.

LPT5 Burrowing Animals

Burrowing animals such as rabbits, moles and badgers shall as far as possible be actively discouraged from colonising the site to avoid any negative impact on below ground archaeology. Any means employed to discourage burrowing animals shall be undertaken in strict accordance with all relevant legislation and good practice guidance.

LPT6 Vehicular Access

Vehicular access shall be restricted to vehicles directly related to the management of the site, although emergency service vehicles shall be granted full access. Given the nature of the soils in this part of Swindon, vehicular access should be prohibited when the ground is soft orsaturated to prevent wheel rutting and damage to below ground archaeology.

LPT7 Collectors and Metal Detectors

Unauthorised treasure hunting can damage the archaeological resource and can lead to a reduction in the understanding of the historic environment if finds are removed or taken out of the context of the site. Unauthorised treasure hunting, archaeological collection and the use of metal detectors shall be prohibited within the area of known archaeology.

LPT8 Consultation with Archaeological Advisor to SBC

It is of the upmost importance that there are no negative impacts to the heritage resource at the Site. Where proposals have the potential to impact the buried archaeological resource early consultation with the Archaeological Advisor to SBC should be undertaken. Although undesirable with regard to the preservation of the heritage resource; where archaeological mitigation is unavoidable, no works shall be conducted without prior consultation and consent from the Archaeological Advisor to SBC.

Long Term Site Condition Assessment

7.7 It has been agreed in consultation with the Archaeological Advisor to SBC that the introduction of a regularly repeatable Site Condition Assessment must be an integral part of any long-term preservation strategy for the Site. Every effort has been made to predict potential long-term impacts to the Site during its operational phase, however, un-intended or un-envisaged impacts are possible, and it is of the upmost importance that should any further negative impacts because at the Site, that those impacts are identified, and remedial action be taken promptly.

7.8 It is recommended that the Site Condition Assessment be conducted at three month intervals for the first two years of the operation phase of the Site. The Site Condition Assessment should be undertaken by a CIFA registered Organisation, in accordance with the approved detailed Written Scheme of Investigation for the relevant phase and in consultation with the Archaeological Advisor to SBC. This will enable any immediate impacts to be identified, assessed and resolved accordingly. The quarterly survey programme will maximise the potential to isolate any seasonal impacts which might not be obvious at other times of the year. The application period of these shorter assessment intervals may need to be extended if there are any pressing or outstanding negative impacts which need to be monitored closely. It must be the decision of the Local Planning Authority as to when the shorter assessment intervals can be terminated.

7.9 Following this initial period of closely spaced assessment, and assuming any seasonal or pressing issues, if any, have been resolved, it is recommended that the Site Condition Assessment be conducted at five yearly intervals.

7.10 It is imperative for the validity of the Site Condition Assessment, that the same criteria are assessed each time the survey is conducted. This will enable rapid assessment of the findings and allow comparison between datasets.

7.11 It is recommended that a specific Site Condition Assessment format is developed, which is agreeable to all concerned parties and approved by the Local Planning Authority. A copy of the Survey should be made readily and promptly available to the Archaeological Advisor to SBC, so an action plan regarding the implementation of any necessary remedial measures can be devised.

7.12 The Site Condition Assessment is intended to be conducted in one day or less, depending on the number of impacts observed. It is intended a single sheet Impact Form be completed for each impact observed at the Site (see below). The Impact Forms would be accompanied with a digital photographic record of any observed impacts and general shots of the Site, and a cover letter detailing the results of the Survey. This would be made available to the Local Planning Authority within 20 working days for monitoring purposes.

7.13 In the event that no negative impacts are observed at the Site, a cover letter including general photographic shots of the Site should be forwarded to the Local Planning Authority within 20 working days.

7.14 Criteria for the Site Condition Assessment Impact Form and a template will be provided at detailed stage for each phase.

Sources

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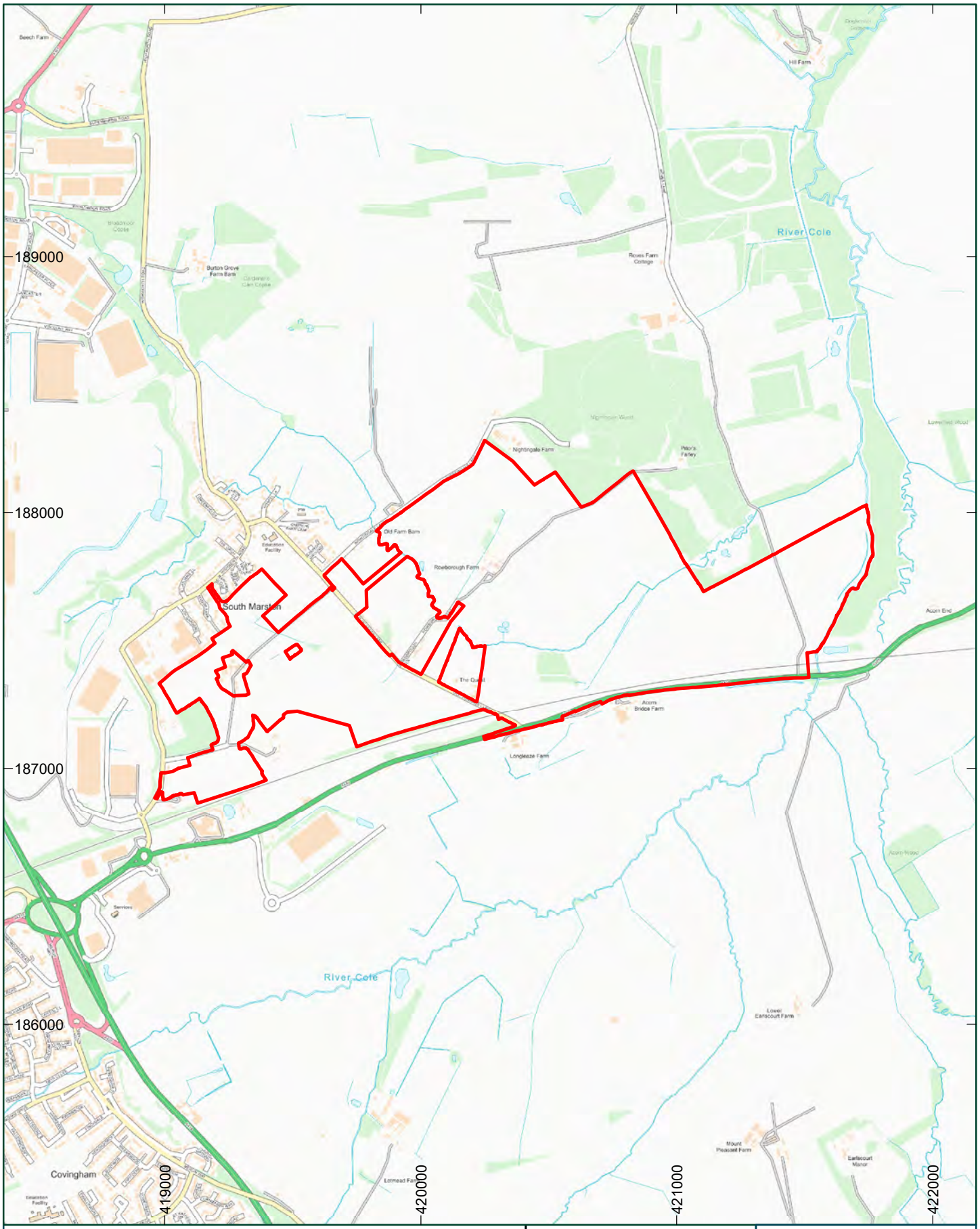


Legend

Outline Application Site Boundary

1:20,000 at A4

0 500m

N

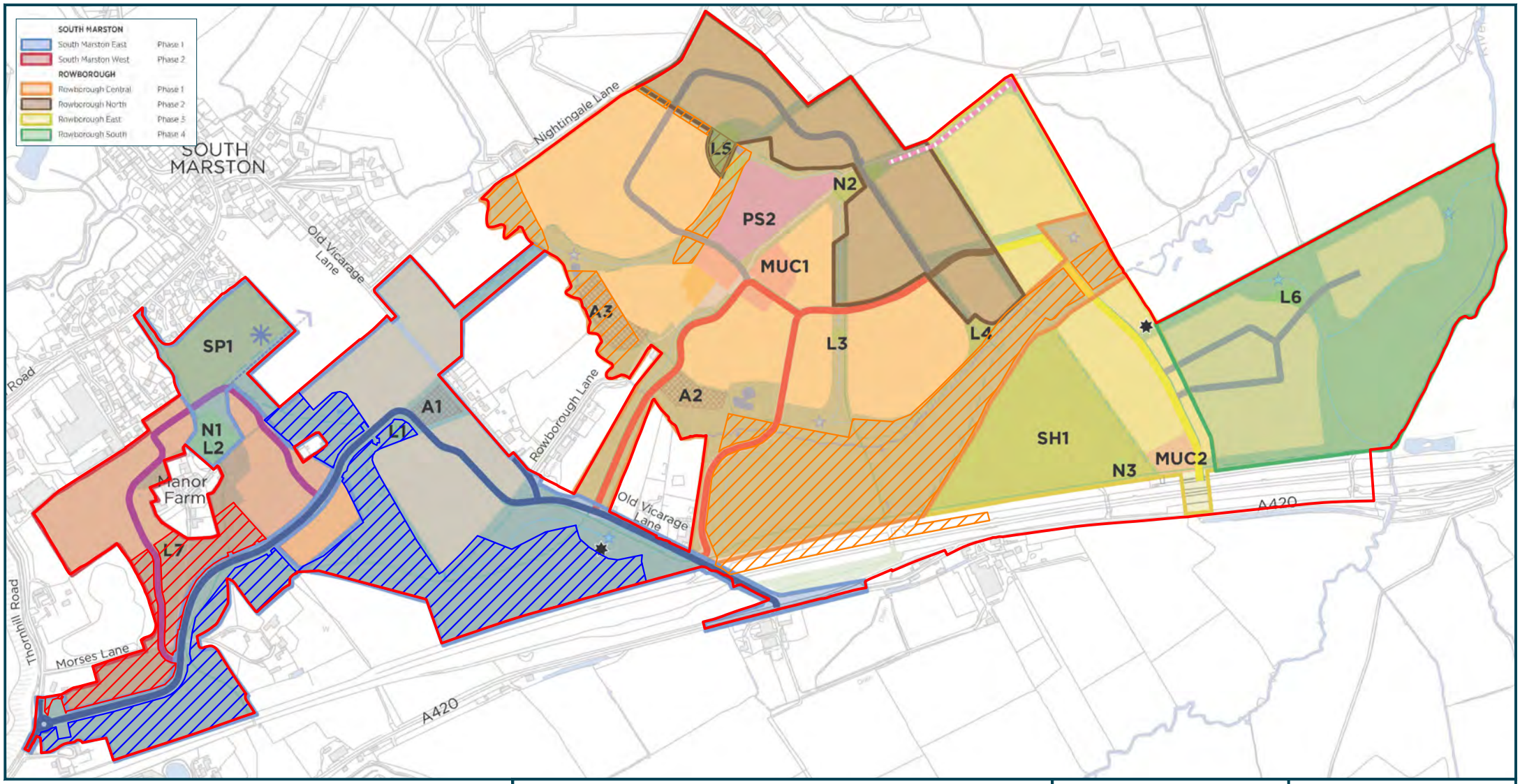
Title:

Figure 1: Site Location

Address:

Land at South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon

orion.



Legend:

- Site Boundary
- Preservation Area 1
- Preservation Area 2
- Preservation Area 3
- Preservation Area 4

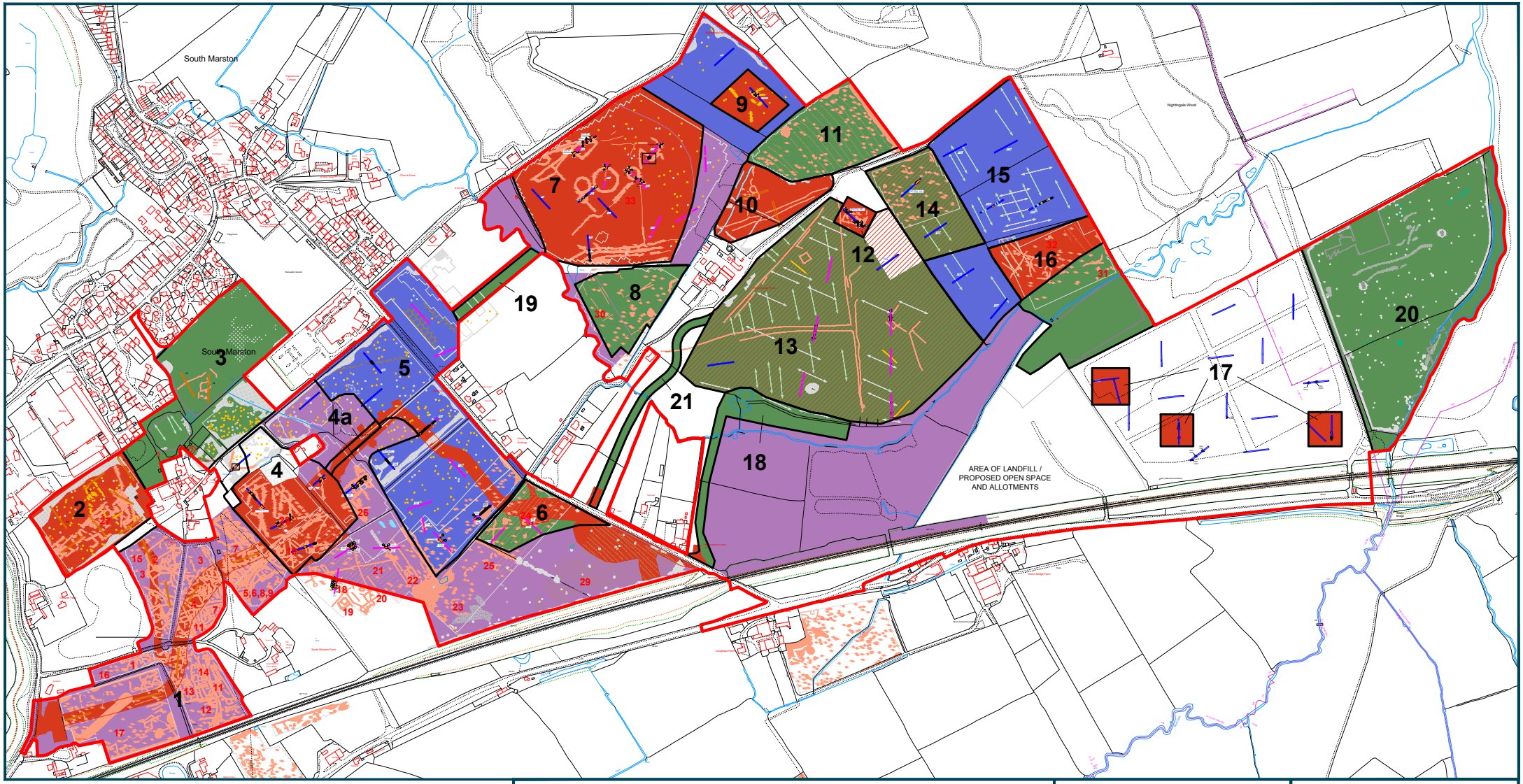
0 250 m

Title:
Figure 2: Area of the Archaeological Management and Development Phasing Plan

Address:
Land at South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon

N

orion.



Legend:
- Area requiring management
- Areas of excavation
- Areas assumed to require excavation following further trenching
- Development areas requiring no further work
- Areas of further evaluation trenching & possible further mitigation

1:10000 at A4:

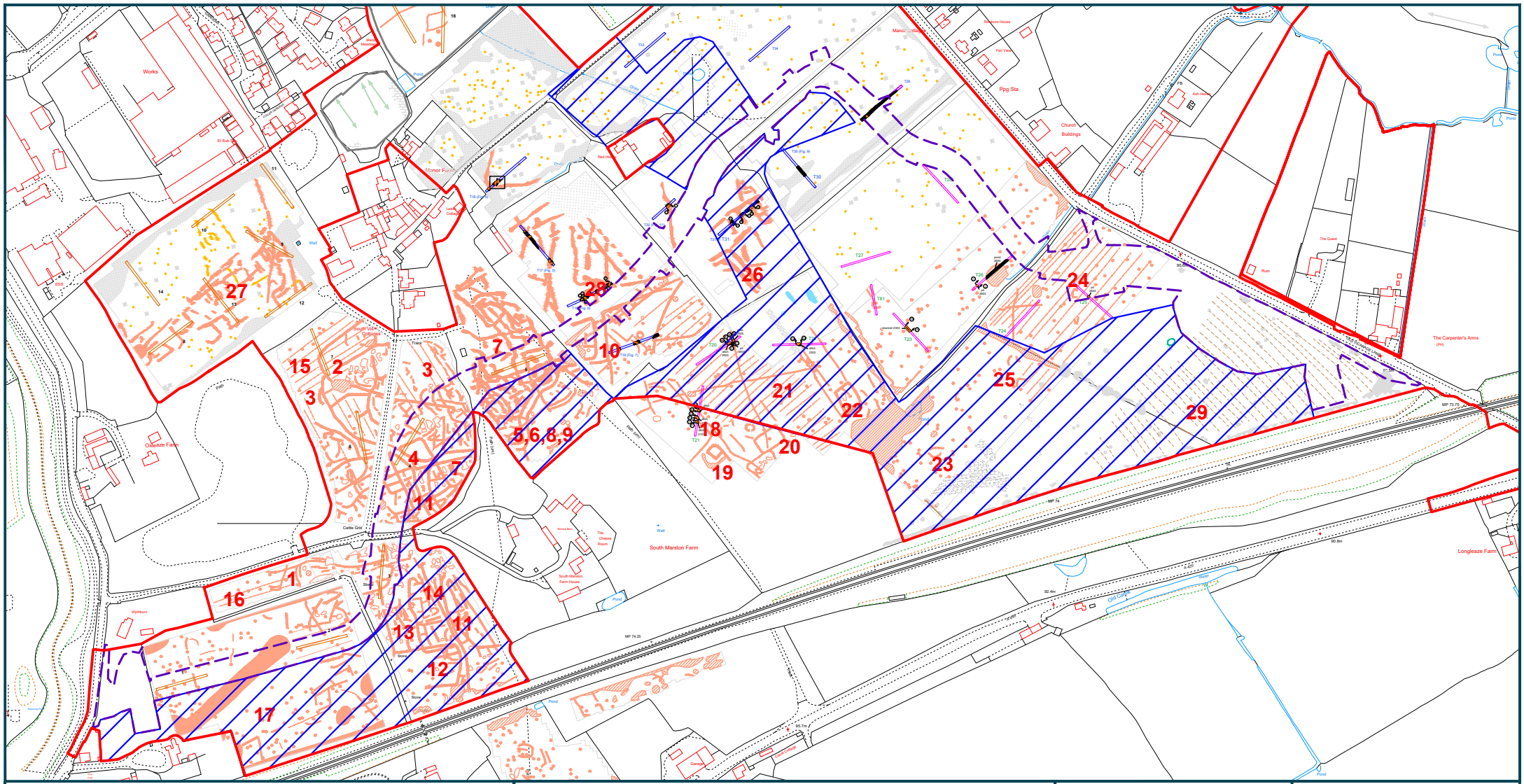
0 250 m

Title: Figure 3: Areas of excavation, areas of further works, areas requiring no further archaeological works and area of the management plan

Address:
Land at South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon

N

orion.



Construction Phase Activity requiring review

Access

---- Temporary Haul Road Construction Fence

Ecology / Landscape

Services

Legend:

Preservation Area 1

0 125 m

Title:

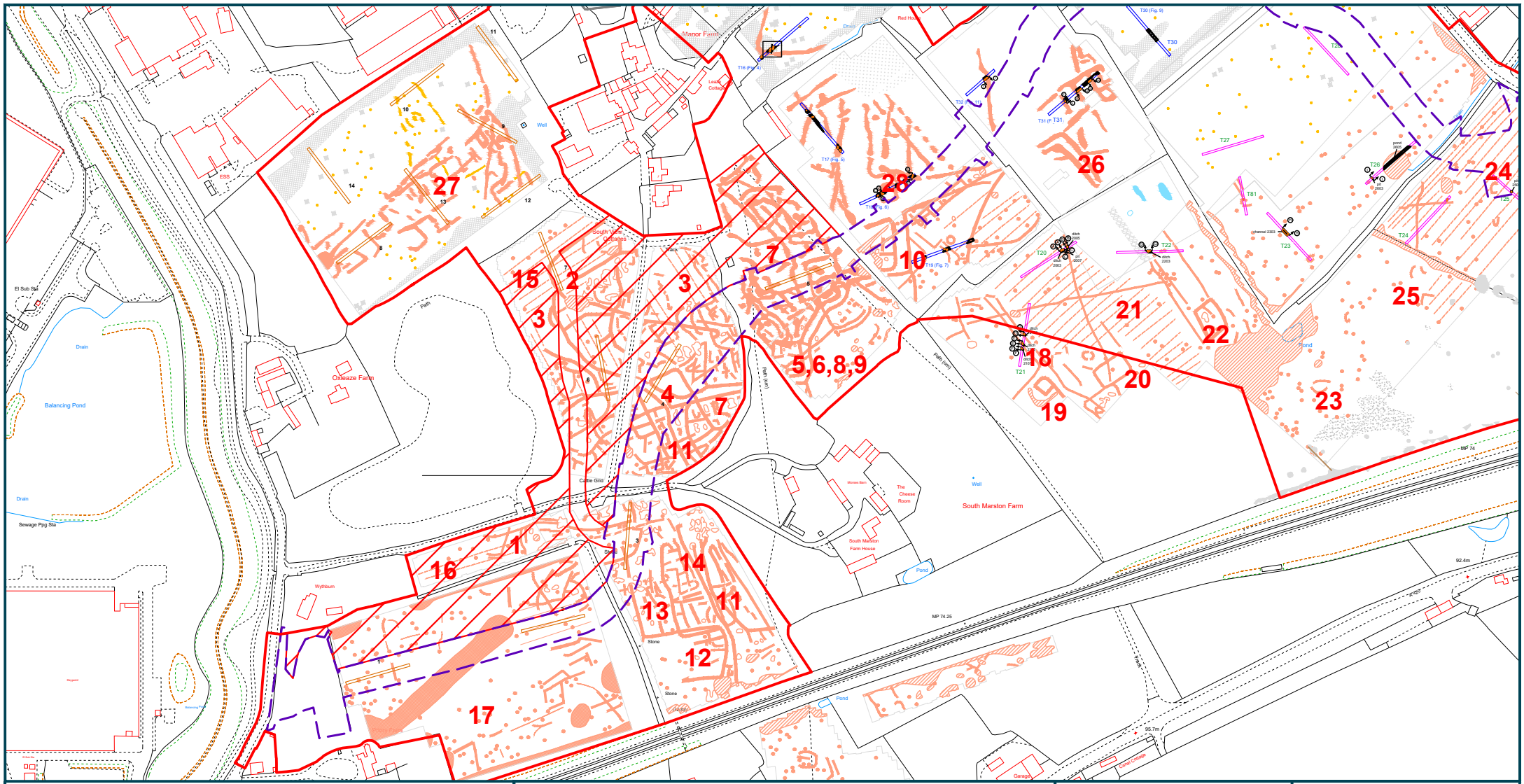
Figure 4: Preservation Area 1 / South Marston East (Phase 1)

Address:

Land at South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon

N

orion.



Construction Phase Activity requiring review

Access

- - - - Temporary Haul Road Construction Fence

Ecology / Landscape

Services

Legend:

Preservation Area 2

0 100m

Title:

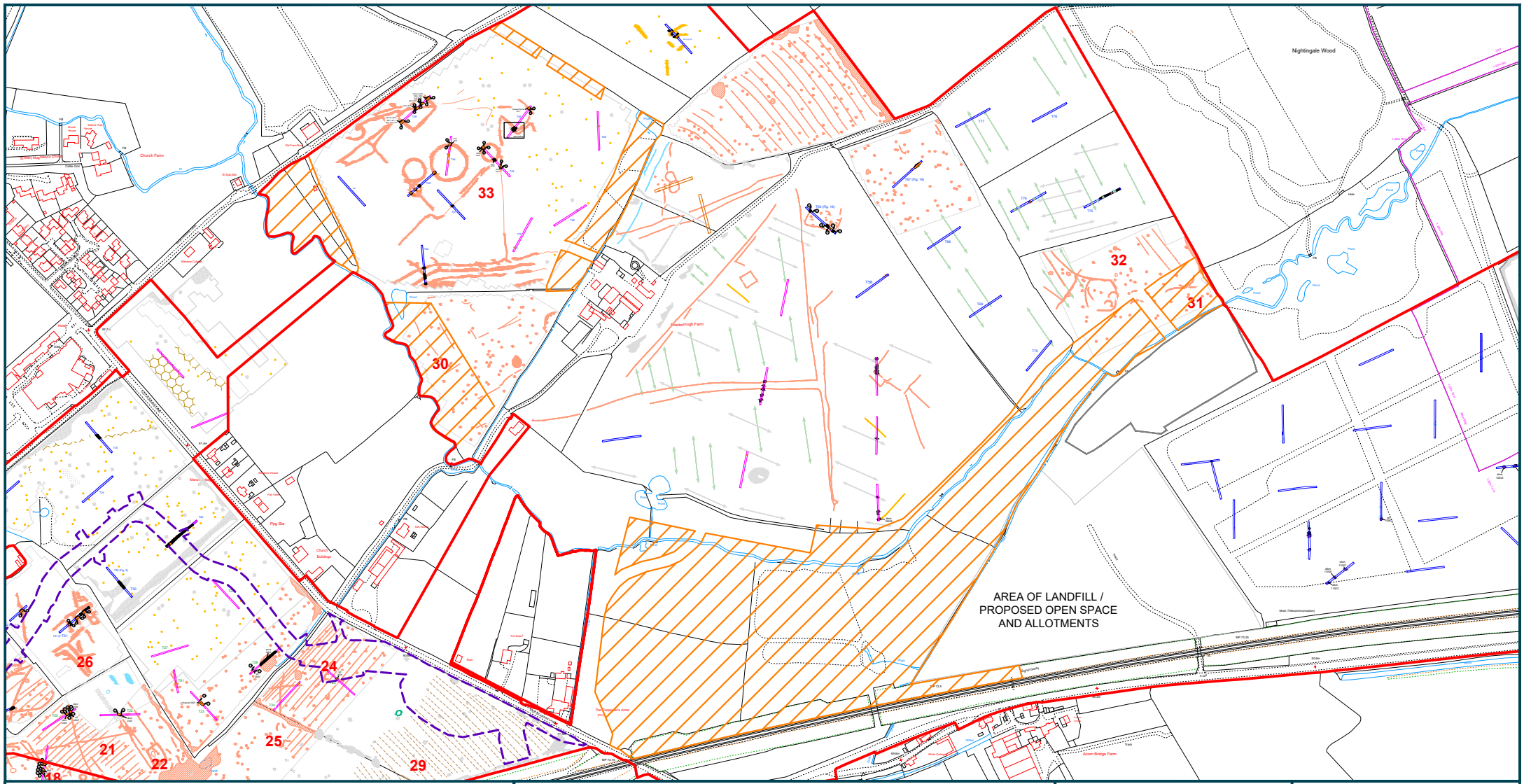
Figure 5: Preservation Area 2 / South Marston West (Phase 2)

Address:

Land at South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon

N

orion.



Construction Phase Activity requiring review

Access

- - - - Temporary Haul Road Construction Fence

Ecology / Landscape

Services

Legend:

Preservation Area 3

0 150 m

Title:

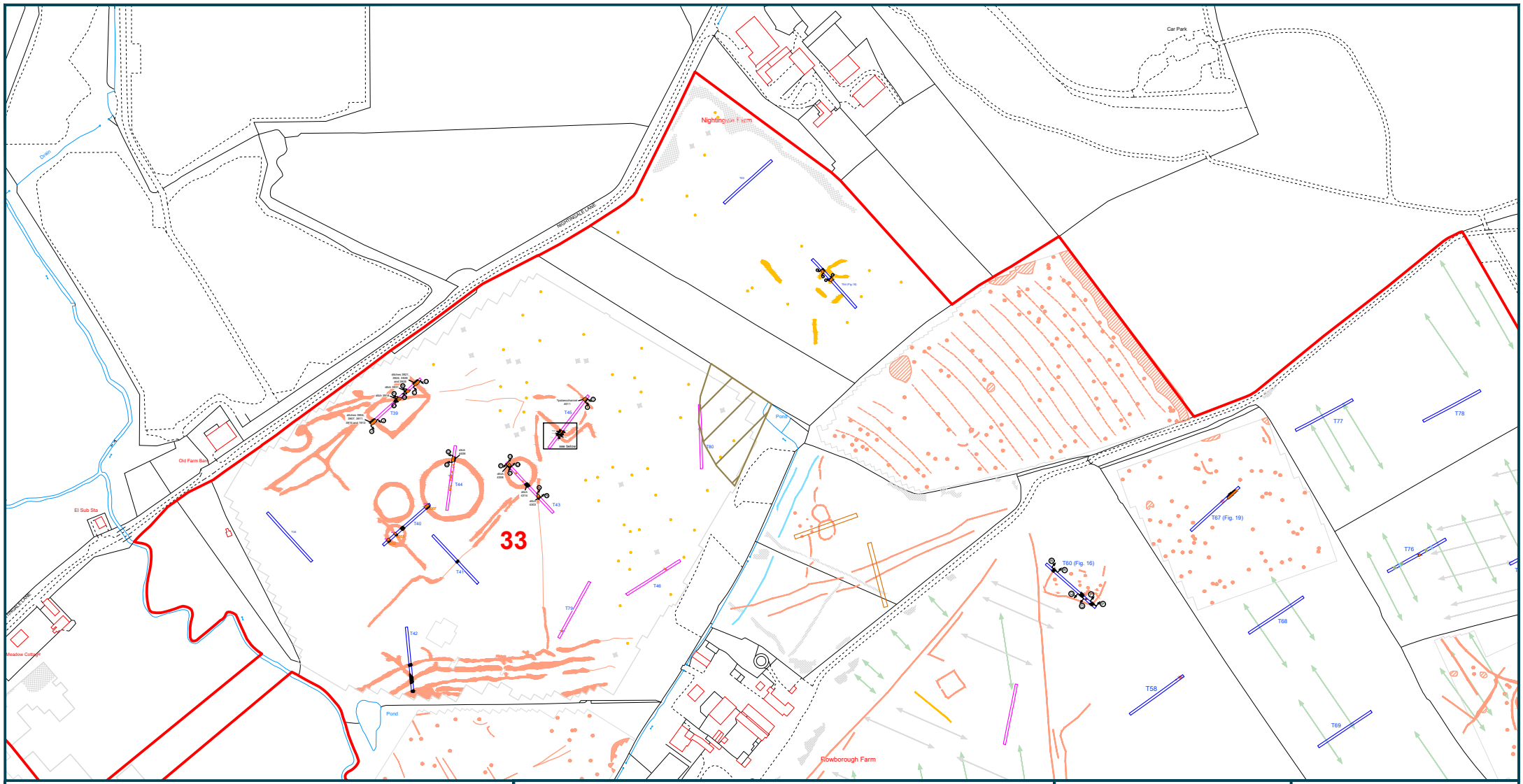
Figure 6: Preservation Area 3 / Rowborough Central (Phase 1)

Address:

Land at South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon

N

orion.



Construction Phase Activity requiring review

Access

---- Temporary Haul Road Construction Fence

Ecology / Landscape

Services

Legend:

Preservation Area 4

0 100 m

Title:

Figure 7: Preservation Area 4 / Rowborough North (Phase 2)

Address:

Land at South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon

N

orion.